

The NIL Money Starter Checklist

7 moves to make *before* you spend a dollar of NIL money.

Getting NIL money is exciting — but a few simple moves now protect it for life. Do these in order. Check each box as you go. **No experience needed.**

1 Move 30% to taxes — immediately
Your check is NOT all yours. Nobody withholds taxes on NIL money. The day it lands, move **30% into a separate savings account** and forget it exists. Spend it all and tax season becomes a nightmare.

2 Wait 30 days before any big purchase
The excitement is the enemy. Make a rule: **no big buys for 30 days** after a deal. If you still want it after the hype fades, fine — usually you won't.

3 Open a high-yield savings account
A normal bank pays you almost nothing. A **high-yield savings account** pays real interest for the same safety. Keep your tax money and emergency fund here. Takes 5 minutes online.

4 Build a \$1,000 starter emergency fund
Before investing a dime, stash **\$1,000** for life's surprises so one bad week can't wreck everything. Build toward 3–6 months of expenses over time.

5 Kill any credit card debt
Card debt at 20%+ interest beats almost any investment you could make. **Pay it off first** — it's a guaranteed return you can't get anywhere else.

6 Open a Roth IRA & buy a low-cost index fund
The boring secret to wealth: own a tiny piece of thousands of companies, cheaply, and don't touch it. A **Roth IRA** makes the growth tax-free forever. Starting young is a superpower.

7 Learn the one question that saves a fortune
Before you let ANYONE manage your money, ask: **"Are you a fee-only fiduciary, and how exactly do you get paid?"** A "small" 1% fee can cost you \$300,000+ over your life. Fuzzy answer? Walk away.

You just did more than 95% of athletes ever do. 🏆

This is the starter version. The full **NIL Playbook** shows you exactly how to do each step — the accounts to open, the tax traps to dodge, the scams to avoid, contract red flags, and a year-one plan built for how much you earn.

Get the full NIL Playbook → \$29